

Keeping

Deciding to keep the baby and to be a young parent requires a lot of planning. A doctor refers the new parents to an obstetrician (a doctor who specializes in pregnancy and childbirth). In some cases, a specially trained nurse supports the parents throughout the pregnancy and during the baby's early years.

There are some key things to think about in advance to help with planning:

- Make sure everyone who will be affected is aware, including the partner, family, and friends.
- Ask the doctor if there are any local nurses and/or midwives who specialize in working with young parents.
- Look for local groups where teen parents can meet other new parents.
- Investigate what support is given to young parents at schools and colleges, so that there is as little disruption to education as possible.
- Seek help with things such as running errands or looking after the baby, if possible.

Terminating

Also known as “abortion,” termination is a safe, medical way of ending a pregnancy, which is arranged by a doctor or sexual health clinic. It's possible to have a termination without friends or family knowing, if a teen is more comfortable keeping it private. However, having support from someone—such as a parent, partner, or friend—can help.

Medical termination

- This type of termination takes place within the first 10 weeks of pregnancy. Pills are prescribed to be taken 24 or 48 hours apart, which induce a miscarriage. There is no need to be in hospital.

Surgical termination

- A surgical termination takes place after the first 10 weeks of pregnancy. A doctor performs a minor procedure, in a hospital or clinic and with anaesthetic, to remove the fetus. After a certain point in a pregnancy, it can no longer be legally terminated, but the law about when this point occurs varies between countries.

Teens may have different reactions after an abortion—some may feel relieved, while others may experience sadness and distress. Medical complications are uncommon.